

LCD screens on headphones

Vizio made its foray into the headphone market with a pair of Bluetooth headphones with an LCD screen on each earpiece that displays album art and other images

Netbooks go a little retro

Acer and Gateway announced netbooks with optical drives bridging the gap between netbooks and notebooks



MSI's Gx740 offers surround sound in Netbooks

GX640 and GX740 are powered by i5 processor and features the ATI Radeon HD directx 11 supporting video card. The Gx740 has five speakers for what MSI calls "The ultimate 3D sound experience in netbooks." They both will start retailing in UK in 2010 and will have a price tag of £999. Dell also showed its 11 inch alienware netbook that will cost less than \$1000. It has nVidia's GT335M graphics and is capable of running Crysis at 50 FPS. It has a battery life of 2 hours in gaming

on the application running on your system.

HP Mini 5102 went a step further in the netbook segment by coming out with a touch-enabled netbook. With features like face recognition for logging onto windows and multi touch sensor, HP Mini has raised the bar for netbooks. It comes with a four-cell or a six-cell battery, the latter can last up to 10 hours.

ATI also revealed the much awaited range of its Directx 11 supporting notebook graphic cards. The entire announced range of laptop graphic cards include ATI Mobility Radeon HD 5800, ATI Mobility Radeon HD 5700, ATI Mobility Radeon HD 5600 and ATI Mobility Radeon HD 5400 series graphics. MSI unveiled netbooks based on the Intel Calpella platform. The C-series and G-series range of laptops use Core i5 processors. MSI's

mode, although it goes up when the game runs at lower levels. Sony also revealed its Vaio F series notebook which will cater to both home cinema and powerful office users. It has a slick black chassis and a Full HD 16.4 inch display. It runs on Windows 7 home premium. Dell also wowed the crowd with the demonstration of its OLED notebook. The Studio XPS has an OLED display with a depth of just 2mm. It has a pretty impressive contrast of 10,000:1. HP also displayed a concept notebook running Android with a Qualcomm processor and full 3G support.

Netbook purchases have seen a steady rise in 2009 and this growth is bound to continue with more performance being packed in. With tablet PCs about to make an entry in the consumer market, the battle for portable computing is just going to heat up.

Television sets to get a dimensional lift soon

Over the past year, 3D has been slowly gaining ground as a home theatre experience. Concert videos of U2 and Miley Cyrus were released in 3D, and the year ended with the release of Avatar. At CES, 3D HDTV was dominating trend, with the biggest television manufacturers in the industry including Panasonic, LG, Sony, Philips, Vizio, Samsung and Toshiba, all showcasing 3D HDTV products.

The definite showstealers amongst these was Panasonic's 158 Inch plasma behemoth, a device that can churn out video at 4K resolution. 1080p resolution is 1K, and 4K is the standard at which the best cameras in the media industry record, which is basically what you see in theatres. The only heavier format around is IMAX. This of course, put's a lot of pressure on the consumer in terms of getting together the resources necessary to feed this monster. If you

means that whatever device you are using as a source has to output twice the amount of image information in the same amount of time, as there is a different image for each eye. Nonetheless, a few of the 3D HDTVs showcased at CES are market ready. Samsung's wafer thin (1/3rd of an inch) LED9000 was also quite a spectacle. The remote that controls this device may just be the long awaited iPhone killer. You can stream videos, use Wi-Fi, and even watch a secondary channel on the remote itself.

Sharp came out with a stunner in the form of three Aquos LED LCD TVs, sets that uses four basic pixels instead of the standard three. A yellow pixel has been thrown into the array, to give a better colour representation. Sony had showcased 3D models in CES 2009 itself, and some of the sets in the Bravia range is already 3D ready. The models showcased in the 2010 exhibit used an OLED screen. Sony announced that they would tie in with content providers such as Discovery channel for



The LED9000 remote



Panasonic's 3D HD camcorder

got yourself a Blu-Ray player already, there's bad news for being an early adapter, as you will need ports on it which are in the new HDMI 1.4 standard, something that supports the 3D HDTV Blu-Ray format. 3D Blu-Ray also